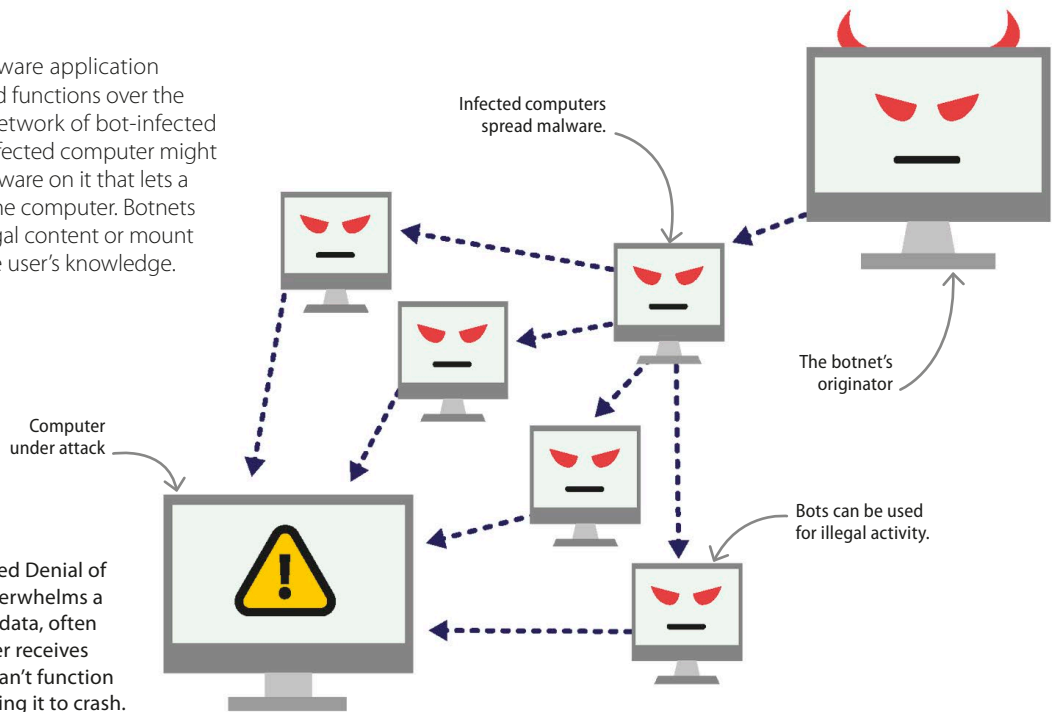


Botnets

An internet bot is a software application that performs automated functions over the internet. A botnet is a network of bot-infected computers. While the infected computer might run normally, there's software on it that lets a "puppet master" hijack the computer. Botnets can be used to store illegal content or mount cyberattacks without the user's knowledge.



▷ DDoS attacks

DDoS stands for Distributed Denial of Service. A DDoS attack overwhelms a server by flooding it with data, often sent by botnets. The server receives so many requests that it can't function properly, sometimes causing it to crash.

◁ Backdoors

A backdoor allows users to bypass all regular security checks, such as passwords and permission settings. Sometimes, backdoors are created by accident when developers leave a loophole in the software. Other times, they are installed by malicious code.

◁ Ransomware

Ransomware sneaks onto a computer and encrypts files, effectively holding them for ransom. Unless attackers are paid, everything on the computer is inaccessible. Ransomware uses strong encryption protocols. It's almost impossible to break the code without paying for access to the key.

◁ Hybrid threats

Programs that have characteristics of multiple types of malware are called hybrid threats. A worm may drop a virus on a computer, or it may behave like a trojan. Classification provides a starting point for identification and defence, but each threat must be neutralized individually.

IN DEPTH

Cookies

Cookies are small files stored inside the browser cache, which is a temporary storage location for downloaded files. Websites send cookies to a computer to keep track of sessions, making it possible to log in and out of online accounts. However, some cookies track activity across multiple sites. While cookies don't contain personal information, hackers can steal a session by intercepting them. This could give them access to information, such as credit card details, stored on a user's account.